

**SYNTHETIC TRAINING RECORD — FICTIONAL PARTIES, PEOPLE,  
OFFICES, IDENTIFIERS, AND EVENTS — NOT A REAL FILING OR  
PRESENTENCE REPORT**

# **Motion to Continue Lower-Record Seal and File Public/Sealed Appellate Twins**

**United States Court of Appeals for the Fourth Circuit United States v. Mateo Serrano**  
Appeal No. SYN-CA4-26-CR-4201 Document 7 Filed April 1, 2026

Mateo Serrano moves under Fourth Circuit Local Rule 25(c) to preserve the existing confidentiality of presentence materials transmitted from the district court and to file four precisely defined public/sealed appellate pairs. The relief is limited to information derived from the presentence report, objection packet, protected sentencing memoranda, and separate PSR volume.

The requested public side will remain fully usable for docketing, briefing, navigation, and ordinary review. Three brief pairs will use equal-page public-redacted and sealed-highlighted counterparts. The PSR appendix pair will instead use an equal-page public docket surrogate and index; it will never be described as a public-redacted presentence report.

Bram Ives states that the fictional United States does not oppose continued protection of material already sealed by rule, subject to adequate public counterparts and this court's independent review. No broader sealing of public legal analysis, party identities, dates, disposition requests, or ordinary docket events is requested.

## **Lower-Record Confidentiality**

The certified district record contains four paired presentence disclosures. Public docket surrogates identify the PSR packet, objection packet, defense sentencing memorandum, and government sentencing memorandum. Their sealed synthetic twins remain distinct files. The public entries are category notices, not redacted versions of the underlying papers.

The district confidentiality arose automatically under the then-effective local rules governing presentence reports, responses, objections, and sentencing submissions. Serrano does not ask this court to invent a new factual premise or to convert a rule-based seal into permanent secrecy. He asks only that the protected status continue while the appeal uses the material necessary to address the role and allocution questions.

The Judicial Conference policy excluding presentence reports from the public criminal file further supports use of a public surrogate for the separate PSR volume. At the same time, legal propositions, public transcript facts, the exact sentence, and the relief sought can remain visible. Continued protection should track confidential content, not entire subjects or documents without differentiation.

## **Appellate Authority and Narrow Tailoring**

Local Rule 25(c) requires a party filing sealed material to identify the authority for confidentiality, explain why sealing is necessary, and provide an appropriate public version. Serrano will file a certificate alongside this motion that lists every protected pair, the lower source of confidentiality, page equality, service method, and proposed duration.

Less restrictive alternatives have been incorporated. Public briefs will state the waiver language through safe paraphrase and fragments, identify the five-participant role dispute, describe the complete allocution denial from the public transcript, and request exact relief. Only synthetic personal detail and protected probation analysis will be replaced with approved fictional redaction tokens. The public PSR appendix will contain categorical navigation rather than report text.

The requested seal lasts only while the underlying presentence confidentiality continues or until further order. Any party seeking broader disclosure may move on notice. The court can review each pair page by page. Serrano does not request closure of argument, sealing of a published opinion, or removal of an ordinary public docket entry.

## **Exact Four-Pair Inventory**

The first pair is the opening brief: a sixteen-page public-redacted counterpart and a sixteen-page sealed-highlighted twin. The second is the government's allocution response: fourteen public pages and fourteen sealed pages. The third is Serrano's reply: eight public pages and eight sealed pages. Each pair will preserve the same subjects at the same offsets while using independently worded public and protected text.

The fourth pair is a six-page public docket surrogate and index for a six-page separate sealed PSR appendix volume. The surrogate will provide category, provenance, and navigation information only. It will not paraphrase personal history or reproduce a report with blackouts.

No other appellate document is covered by this motion. The government threshold motion, opposition, target-limited dismissal order, calendar notice, eventual merits decision, judgment, and mandate remain public. If a later filing unexpectedly requires different protected content, the filing party must seek specific relief rather than assuming that this motion automatically extends to it.

# Synthetic Access and Verification Protocol

Within the fictional workbench, eligibility to view a sealed twin does not itself open the file. A session grant must identify the particular disclosure and the exact resolved exercise-package identity. A grant for one pair supplies no authority for another. Public access continues to resolve to the corresponding redacted brief or docket surrogate.

Every authorized open must independently verify the content-addressed path, declared byte size, cryptographic digest, PDF readability, and exact page count before exposing a leased snapshot. A missing path, symbolic-link substitution, size mismatch, digest mismatch, unreadable PDF, or wrong page count requires denial. Cached success from an earlier open cannot replace the new verification.

Revocation removes the sealed row, closes any protected view, and restores the public projection. Recovery after a corrected storage condition requires a new successful verification under an unexpired grant. These controls describe only synthetic software behavior. They do not represent a real PACER session, CM/ECF permission, probation disclosure, or counsel credential.

## Requested Order and Certification

Serrano asks the court to continue lower-record confidentiality, authorize the four exact pairs, require the filed certificate, and maintain public access to every counterpart. He asks that any order state that page equality, semantic correspondence, disclosure-specific authorization, and per-open verification are conditions of the synthetic projection rather than substitutes for the governing legal seal.

Arden certifies that she conferred with Ives. The fictional United States does not oppose the requested structure but reserves any argument about whether a particular sentence in a sealed brief actually requires protection. That reservation allows narrow review without defeating the four-pair protocol.

No real PSR, personal information, court system, credential, or sealed filing was used to create this motion. All cited people, offices, and events are fictional. The motion is public and contains enough information to evaluate necessity, alternatives, scope, and duration without exposing any protected twin.

Respectfully submitted April 1, 2026.

**Celia Arden** Fictional Counsel for Mateo Serrano